



Autocomplete broken

Gmail's autocomplete has been giving us trouble, and Google admitted as much.
<http://dgit.in/AutoBroken>



Band improved

An update to Microsoft's Band added a lot more functionality to the wearable, making it quite useful: http://dgit.in/Band_Upd

larger section of the population will have to be immunised to prevent a disease from spreading. This is called herd immunity.

Different diseases have different transmission rates and therefore different immunity targets. Mumps only requires a 75% vaccination rate (3 out of 4) since the evidence shows that it isn't as transmissible as measles, which is so bad, it needs a 95% vaccination rate to prevent an epidemic. Some children will always be too young or too sick to be vaccinated, but a 95% coverage rate ensures that even if a healthy person is infected, he or she will not spread the disease.

Given the fact that more deadly diseases like smallpox and polio have now been eradicated through vaccination, and that measles is similarly on the decline, you would think that parents would not have a problem with vaccination. Indeed, given the millions of lives saved over the last century, you would think that parents would be crazy not to have their kids vaccinated. However, a lot of American parents deliberately refuse vaccination. They are colloquially referred to as anti-vaxxers. Which brings us to the various beliefs people have about vaccination, and how valid they are.

Do anti-vaxxers have a valid point?

Even though countries like the US allow some parents to opt out of vaccines because of religious or personal beliefs, evidence shows that even the most religious communities are happy to have their children vaccinated. Instead, the main reason parents cite in refusing vaccinations is safety concerns.

• Vaccines cause autism

This belief can be traced back to a TV interview on Oprah where actress Jenny McCarthy linked autism to vaccination, without any scientific evidence. There was also a 1998 study in the Lancet medical journal that is used as a basis for this link. However, this paper was retracted for poor selection bias in using sample sizes. It was also found that the medical records of all 12 patients in the study were altered or misrepresented. All follow up studies and meta-analyses (analyses of all previous studies on the topic) have not only found no

link between the MMR vaccine and autism, but have also found that the vaccine is safe. Studies have also found that there has been no spike in autism cases after the MMR vaccine was introduced, nor is there a clustering of autism cases in children directly after vaccination.

• Over vaccination can hurt your immune system

There is absolutely no evidence to support this.



Unlike the person in the image, it is best to get vaccinated when significantly younger

• Vaccinating for each disease separately is better than the 3 in one MMR vaccine

Again, there is no evidence to support this, and giving the vaccines separately increases the risk of infection between vaccines.

• Vaccine science is based on shaky claims

The best thing about living in the internet age is the ease at which you can conduct your own personal research. A visit to Google Scholar, PubMed or NCBI to read the scientific literature should leave you with no doubt as to the science behind these claims.

• Vaccines could be wrong because science has been wrong before

Yes, science has been wrong before, but this is no reason to doubt that vaccines are wrong given the evidence to the contrary.

• Vaccines contain mercury

This is false according to the World Health Organisation. Some vaccines used to contain trace amounts of preservatives, but the data shows us that vaccines work, and that side effects are minimal.

Vaccines are a one-size-fits-all approach to a complex problem

This is generally true, and you should discuss any concerns you have about particular vaccines and side effects with your doctor. Also, vaccines are getting better all the time, and vaccines today are shown to be effective. Would you rather not vaccinate your kids?

• Vaccines are not completely effective

This is true, but not a good reason to remain unvaccinated. In fact it should prompt parents to do just the opposite.